Beacon Digest -- 2026-11-03

Linux

[$] The second part of the 7.4 merge window

Source: LWN.net

> The 7.4 merge window, which closed on November 1, included a record-breaking 18,591 non-merge changesets. That is almost as many as the entire 7.3 development cycle, which had 18,765, itself a record breaker. Of those, 11,838 landed after the article covering the first part of the merge window . Mos...

Shutting the Door on the XCPE Botnet (Threat Intelligence)

Source: LWN.net

> The Google Threat Intelligence blog describes, in great detail , the XCPE botnet, which has just been taken down. Last week, Google and industry partners dismantled the XCPE backdoor which enrolled more than 1.3 million set-top boxes into a botnet. We assess with high confidence that the backdoor an...

[$] Managing the kernel CVE flood

Source: LWN.net

> We recently looked at how the kernel community is dealing with the firehose of vulnerability reports, but said little about how users of the kernel are responding. At the 2026 Linux Plumbers Conference , Amazon employees Dylan Johnson and Justinien Bouron discussed the problem from the point of view...

Tor Browser 16.0 released

Source: LWN.net

> Version 16.0 of the Tor Browser has been released. This is the first stable version based on Firefox ESR 153. Notable changes in this release include support for Linux on 64-bit Arm, redesigned settings, and a "generic window titles" feature to help prevent other applications from snooping on one's...

Security updates for Monday

Source: LWN.net

> Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (firefox, java-17-openjdk, kernel, kernel-rt, mariadb:10.5, podman, python-jwt, python27:2.7, python38:3.8 and

> python38-devel:3.8, python39:3.9 and python39-devel:3.9, ruby:2.5, ruby:2.7, thunderbird, util-linux, and virt:rhel and virt-devel:rhel), Debi...

What’s new in Red Hat OpenShift migration advisor: Clearer reports and smarter planning

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Red Hat OpenShift migration advisor helps you assess your VMware inventory of virtual machines (VMs) and plan migrations to Red Hat OpenShift Virtualization. Over the past few months, we’ve focused on making assessments easier to read and share, and more useful when you’re working across multiple in...

Sovereignty in the AI era: Choice, control, and autonomy

Source: Red Hat Blog

> For the past few years, AI felt like a high-stakes exhibition game. Teams across every industry were on the pitch experimenting with large language models, running rapid proofs-of-concept, and testing what was possible. That period of passive experimentation is officially over. AI has now moved dire...

What’s Happening In KDE Remote Desktop – Improved Unattended Mode and More

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> Remote desktop has been one of the weaker areas of the transition to Wayland. There's a lot of software written exclusively for X that has a direct Wayland equivalent. Within KDE, we already have a Plasma-native RDP and VNC solution for Wayland, but we're aware that it hasn't yet reached the level w...

Wayland pain points – kgamma

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> In the feedback about dropping X11 support, one very surprisingly common comment is from users saying they "need" kgamma, a simple tool that allows the user to adjust the gamma, red, blue and green that gets drawn to the screen operating directly on the X server. On our Wayland session we have colou...

Techpaladin are hiring!

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> If you've been around KDE, you've probably heard of Techpaladin Software We're a consultancy that works almost exclusively on KDE, improving KDE upstream while delivering the features and functionality our clients need. We're growing and looking for more developers to join the team. We're after expe...

EX-11: Prepping for Plasma’s Last X11-Supported Release

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> When we first announced the transition to Plasma Wayland, one of Martin's slides from stated, "It's done when it's done!" That talk was 15 years ago! Nothing in software is never truly "done", but as announced previously we are finally at a point where we're ready to retire the X11 and put all our f...

Update on KDE Home Automation (KIOT)

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> This is a effectively a guest blogpost where I, as usual, take the credit for the work someone else has done. Last year ago set out making a home automation <--> Desktop Linux bridge over the Christmas holidays. The idea is that if you're using home automation your PC that you're in front of has ... C...

Setting up distributed compilations with sccache

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> I hate waiting for compilations. For day-to-day it may only be a minute or two, but once you start doing another task, the context switching distracts from what you were doing before and breaks everything up. Life is too short to be waiting for computers. Obviously the first answer is to have a fast...

Introducing QtVarlink

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> I'm writing this blog in the very very early stages of development because I'm 50% sure someone will link me to some existing library that Google failed to find. Varlink Varlink is an IPC mechanism that is gaining popularity in a few places across Linux. It's very simple, JSON blobs over a socket te...

Upcoming changes to Activities in Plasma 6.5

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> Activities' future is a bit unclear at the moment. It overlaps with functionality provided by other services and the user story for how it fits into the desktop is unclear at best. However we also have to acknowledge that some people use activities to create a workflow that works for them. Rather th...

A Roadmap for a modern Plasma Login Manager

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> Plasma's login experience is an area that we know requires some improvement — it works OK in the basic case, but it's very barebones and doesn't handle anything

> beyond that. As a complete desktop experience, it's our job to provide support for the edge cases too. What we want Great out-of-box experi...

Adding Home Automation to KDE

Source: David Edmundson's Blog

> About Home Automation is mostly, as the name implies, about automation. The machine you're in front of all work-day has an awful lot of useful information that can be useful in your home management. I have a script lower my blinds if I turn on the camera during the afternoon as otherwise there's an...

Security

Hackers Exploit BTCPay Server Flaw to Steal Bitcoin and Litecoin From Hot Wallets

Source: The Hacker News

> BTCPay Server, a self-hosted, open-source cryptocurrency payment processor, has urged users to install the latest version of its software in response to reports of Bitcoin and Litecoin being stolen from hot wallets on instances running older versions. "Our investigation found that these attacks targ...

Synology NAS Devices Targeted in Ransomware Attacks Exploiting Patched DSM Flaw

Source: The Hacker News

> Synology is urging customers to update the DiskStation Manager (DSM) software powering its Network Attached Storage (NAS) devices following ransomware attacks. The Taiwanese vendor said it observed threat actors exploiting a vulnerability patched in December 2024 to target devices running outdated v...

New Wave of Refrigeration Cyberattacks Hits Supermarkets Across Europe, Forcing Stores to Pull Food

Source: The Hacker News

> Attackers remotely changed the settings on refrigeration controls at supermarkets in Belgium, Sweden, Estonia and other European countries overnight into Monday, November 2, warming fridges and freezers. No chain reported more than several dozen affected stores, and some had to throw away chilled an...

Attackers Exploit Critical Siemens IoT2050 Flaw to Plant Remote Command Backdoors

Source: The Hacker News

> A maximum-severity security flaw impacting Siemens SIMATIC IoT2050 Advanced devices has come under active exploitation, VulnCheck has revealed. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-58115 (CVSS score: 10.0), is a case of missing authentication for a critical function that could be exploited by an u...

Attackers Target Unpatched CryptoPayment Gateway Flaw That Can Expose Wallet Credentials

Source: The Hacker News

> Threat actors are attempting to exploit an unpatched maximum-severity security vulnerability in the CryptoPayment Gateway WordPress plugin, according to findings from Defused Cyber. The vulnerability in question is CVE-2026-81648, which carries a CVSS score of 10.0. Successful exploitation of the fl...

Weekly Recap: Critical CVEs, Linux DDoS Botnet, Device-Code Phishing, Android Spyware and More

Source: The Hacker News

> Some attacks this week didn't need much of a trick. A fake support call, a trusted extension, a shared link, or a device with no password. Small things that people barely think about. Yet each was enough to cause serious trouble. Then there were the bigger messes. Billions stolen, hidden networks of...

Google Disrupts 1.3 Million-Device Android Botnet, Says TV Box Maker Sold Criminal Access

Source: The Hacker News

> A botnet of more than 1.3 million Android devices, mostly TV set-top boxes, lost control of its servers in late October in a takedown led by Google. Google says it is highly confident that device maker Videostrong intentionally put a backdoor in the boxes and sold access to criminals. They used the...

DarkBlinders Compromises Israeli Target and Iraqi Kurdish Government Cloud Environment

Source: The Hacker News

> Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed details of a cyber espionage campaign targeting Israel and the Kurdistan Region of Iraq by an Iran state-aligned threat actor between August and October 2026. According to a report published by Dream Research Labs, the campaign has led to the compromise of a...

Critical Langflow Flaws Could Let Unauthenticated Attackers Run Code on Servers

Source: The Hacker News

> Two critical flaws in Langflow could let a remote attacker with no account bypass authentication or run arbitrary code, IBM said last week. Langflow is an open-source tool for building AI agents and workflows, and its vulnerability reports go to IBM. Every release from 1.0.0 through 1.12.8 has the f...

Is Your SOC Ready for AI Agents? A Maturity Check Before You Deploy

Source: The Hacker News

> Forty percent of security teams now use AI every day, and another 56% are testing it. Only 4% have no plans to adopt it, according to Prophet Security's State of AI in Security Operations 2026 survey of more than 250 CISOs, SOC leaders and practitioners. For the teams still testing, the next decisio...

General Tech

Sava Trust (YC F25) Is Hiring a Founding Engineer in NYC

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.ycombinator.com/companies/sava-trust-company/jobs Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50350924 Points: 0 # Comments: 0

Anthropic IPO filing: $1.7B quarterly payroll, about $107K per employee monthly

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114428-anthropic-ipo-filing-reveals-17-billion-quarterly-personnel.html Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50350560 Points: 22 # Comments: 10

Revolut moves to self-hosted GLM

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://twitter.com/guilleflorvs/status/2117379073785696395 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50350004 Points: 124 # Comments: 86

Could a modern chess engine on a Pentium have defeated Kasparov in 1996?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://nicholas.carlini.com/writing/2026/algorithmic-improvements-chess.html Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50349276 Points: 55 # Comments: 16

uBlock Origin filter to block autoplay videos in TechCrunch

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://cornfieldlabs.github.io/posts/ublock-stop-techcrunch-autoplay-video/post.html Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50349155 Points: 105 # Comments: 34

Nvidia – open-source auto-ontology

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/NVIDIA/auto-ontology Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50348962 Points: 134 # Comments: 39

Show HN: I built a little browser game to practice Vim commands

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> I made hjkl to help myself remember Vim commands. It’s a little browser game you can play when you want to unwind and get a bit of Vim practice in. There are still a lot of commands I want to add, but I hope someone finds it useful in the meantime :) Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?i...

Open-Source 5G Ran Platforms: A Dual Perspective on Performance and Capabilities

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.25820 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50347464 Points: 42 # Comments: 4

Show HN: Hacker Times, a New York Times-inspired version of Hacker News

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> I thought it would be fun to browse HN as if it were a newspaper. The site updates once an hour. Enjoy! Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50346981 Points: 327 # Comments: 103

DiscImageStudio: burn visible artwork onto CDs, DVDs and Blu-ray discs

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/JiaFeiMiao-K-Cat/DiscImageStudio Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50346849 Points: 269 # Comments: 54

SLAC researchers find proof of altermagnetism, a new magnetic phase

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www6.slac.stanford.edu/news/2026-10-29-slac-researchers-find-proof-altermagnetism-new-magnetic-phase Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50344224 Points: 88 # Comments: 9

Egoless Mathematics in the AI Era

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2026/11/02/egoless-mathematics-in-the-ai-era/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50341736 Points: 171 # Comments: 128

Astra can read and write weights to improve Qwen

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://rikiyat.github.io/blog/weight-space-programming/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50341174 Points: 2783 # Comments: 848

Self-Employed? Solopreneur? NIST Has a Cybersecurity Guide Just for You

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.nist.gov/news-events/news/2026/11/self-employed-solopreneur-nist-has-cybersecurity-guide-just-you Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50340619 Points: 249 # Comments: 73

Polyend releases the Tracker firmware source code

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://polyend.com/whats-up/tracker-the-biggest-update-yet/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50340159 Points: 144 # Comments: 48

Show HN: Subvocal – Talk to your computer without making noise

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Hi HN, we're Aarush and Arnav from The Subvocal Company (YC F26) (https://subvocal.company/). We’re building smart glasses that let you talk to your

> computer without talking out loud. You can mouth words silently and discreetly and the glasses decode them to text at the speed of speech. Here's a v...

Launch HN: Momentic (YC W24) – Agents that catch bugs by using your app

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Hey HN, we’re Wei-Wei and Jeff. We’re building Momentic, QA agents that autonomously plan, explore, and bug-bash controls and user flows in your web, iOS, Android, and (soon) desktop apps to catch bugs. Here’s a demo: https://youtu.be/BFsM-Se1Fh8 We’re both software engineers that spent our careers...

US boy names that became girl names and vice versa

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://namedaisy.com/blog/boy-names-that-became-girl-names Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50339397 Points: 422 # Comments: 407

Show HN: Warsaw in voxels – An interactive 3D map of the city centre

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Explore central Warsaw in voxels - slightly inspired by Minecraft, and MagicaVoxel. You can change the date, time of day and weather, explore the city, or click on a pedestrian to control them (here a bit of inspiration from Dungeon Keeper). Works best on desktop, but I tried to make it usable on mo...

Ask HN: Who is hiring? (November 2026)

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Please state the location and include REMOTE for remote work, REMOTE (US) or similar if the country is restricted, and ONSITE when remote work is not an option. Please only post if you personally are part of the hiring company—no recruiting firms or job boards. One post per company. If it isn't a ho...